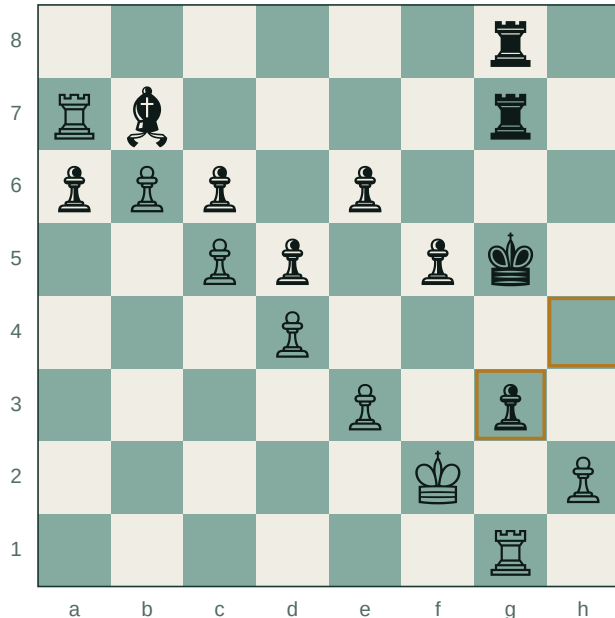


Deflection tactics: White, move 34

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 33...hxg3+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

34. Rxg3+ Kf6 35. Rxb7 Rxb7 36. Rxg8

34.Rxg3+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on g3. Recorded reply: **34...Kf6**.

35.Rxb7 The rook captures the bishop on b7. Recorded reply: **35...Rxb7**.

36.Rxg8 The rook captures the rook on g8.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -4 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g5. Absolute pin: pawn on g3.